

Dear Prof. Wieland Meyer,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my strong interest in the position of Research Technician – Whole Genome Sequencing at the Westerdijk Fungal Biodiversity Institute. With my extensive background in biology I bring a solid academic foundation in life sciences, complemented by hands-on experience in molecular biology, microbiology, and neuroscience research.

Throughout my education, I have received extensive training in laboratory techniques central to molecular biology and genome analysis. During my Bachelor's studies, I built a robust skillset in wet lab methods including PCR, gel electrophoresis, DNA/RNA extraction, qPCR, ELISA, immunohistochemistry, intracellular recordings, and behavioural testing in animal models. My practical experience in physiology and molecular biology was deepened during my year-long role as a Junior Research Assistant at Lomonosov MSU, where I conducted experiments on vascular function and gene expression, contributing conference presentations as well.

During my MSc at Radboud University, I completed a research internship at the Donders Institute where I performed *in vivo* calcium imaging and data analysis using Python and DeepLabCut in a study of neuronal memory networks. This exposure to experimental neuroscience further refined my technical precision and data analysis skills.

My background aligns well with your mission to modernize fungal taxonomy through whole genome sequencing. I am particularly enthusiastic about the opportunity to work with cutting-edge long-read sequencing platforms like Oxford Nanopore and PacBio. I am comfortable working with DNA isolation, electrophoresis, and quality control protocols, and I am eager to develop new competencies in genome assembly and annotation under the mentorship of your interdisciplinary team.

I am motivated to contribute to this impactful research and be part of a close-knit, collaborative, and internationally recognized institute. With my lab skills, attention to detail, and commitment to scientific rigor, I am confident I can add value to your ongoing genomic efforts.

To sum up, I believe that my motivation for research, combined with my comprehensive education and diverse professional experiences, makes me a strong candidate for the position of the Research Technician.

Thank you for considering my application and, in case any questions arise, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards,
Varvara Lazarenko